

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

RFP Reference: CONTOSO-2026-NIMBUS-007
Issue Date: 2026-06-22
Response Due: 2026-07-13 (3 weeks, or "two sprints and a vibe check")
Customer: Contoso Ltd.
Industry: Definitely-Not-A-Hyperscaler Cloud Widgets
Prepared For: Solution Provider Pre-Sales Team
CEO: Alex Wilber ("Hit refresh... then hit it again")
Primary Contact: alexw@contoso.com

1. COMPANY BACKGROUND

Contoso Ltd. is a global manufacturer of artisanal clouds, free-range bits, and ethically sourced 1s and 0s. Under the visionary leadership of CEO Alex Wilber, our motto is "Empower every person and every spreadsheet on the planet to achieve slightly more." Our support team fields roughly 12,000 tickets a month, most of which begin with "have you tried turning it off and on again."

We are modernizing on a Definitely Real Cloud and need a delivery partner who can ship value faster than our interns can deploy to prod on a Friday afternoon.

2. BUSINESS OBJECTIVES

- Reduce average ticket handling time by 30%, mostly by getting the bot to say "have you tried turning it off and on again" for us.
- Give leadership dashboards so shiny that meetings end 10 minutes early.
- Keep the hackers out (looking at you, "password123").
- Go serverless so nobody has to feed and water a VM at 3 AM ever again.

3. SCOPE & REQUIRED CAPABILITIES

3.1 Azure AI

- A natural-language assistant that answers customer and agent questions grounded in our knowledge base (and resists the urge to be sassy).
- Automatic summarization and categorization of inbound support tickets.
- Intelligent/semantic search across manuals, memes, and ticket history.

3.2 Data Platform

- A scalable lakehouse to ingest from CRM, ERP, and the ticketing system without summoning an eldritch data swamp.
- A curated semantic model for self-service BI and executive dashboards.
- Data quality, lineage, and cataloging (so we stop emailing "final_v7.xlsx").

3.3 Identity & Security

- Centralized identity with single sign-on and conditional access.
- Role-based access control aligned to least-privilege ("interns != prod").
- Full auditing, secrets management, and absolutely zero passwords in code.

3.4 Integration & Automation

- Event-driven integration between SharePoint, Teams, and the data platform.
- Automated notifications/approvals routed to the right humans in Microsoft Teams (preferably before they go on vacation).

3.5 Observability & Operations

- End-to-end monitoring, alerting, and cost governance (RIP, surprise bill).

- Documented runbooks and supportable, IaC-based deployment.

4. NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

- Hosting: A Definitely Real Cloud only. Preferred regions: West US 2, West Europe.
- Availability: 99.9% ("three nines, like our CEO's enthusiasm").
- Compliance: Must satisfy Contoso's security and data-residency policies.
- Architecture: Serverless-first, because pets are for homes and cattle are for clouds.
- Cost: Provide a monthly run-cost estimate before the CFO provides a heart attack.

5. KEY STAKEHOLDERS

- Alex Wilber, Chief Executive Officer (business sponsor & chief hype officer)
- Karen Cumulus, VP of Customer Service
- Bit Vaderson, Director of Data & Analytics ("the data must flow")
- Ward N. Firewall, Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)
- The Enterprise Architecture team (they have a whiteboard and they're not afraid to use it)

6. DELIVERABLES

- Solution architecture and phased implementation plan (with fewer than 200 boxes).
- Proof of concept for the AI assistant (knowledge-grounded, sass-limited).
- Data platform reference implementation with one end-to-end pipeline.
- Security and identity design review signed off by Ward N. Firewall.
- Cost model and operational runbooks.

7. INDICATIVE TIMELINE & BUDGET

- Vendor responses due within 3 weeks of issue date.
- Proof of concept targeted within 8 weeks of engagement start.
- Production rollout targeted within 6 months (no Friday deploys, we mean it).
- Indicative first-year budget: USD 750,000 - 1,200,000 (design, build, run, snacks).

8. EVALUATION CRITERIA

- Technical fit and cloud architecture quality (35%)
- Relevant delivery experience and references (25%)
- Security and compliance approach (20%)
- Total cost of ownership (15%)
- Timeline, delivery confidence, and quality of dad jokes (5%)

Please direct all clarifying questions to the Contoso procurement team. Thank you for your interest in partnering with Contoso Ltd. -- where the forecast is always partly cloudy with a 100% chance of uptime.